

Attack the base of a pawn chain

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

A pawn chain is a diagonal group of pawns supporting one another. The base has no pawn behind it in the chain, making it a natural pressure point. Attacking the head can also work when opening lines is more urgent.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White pawns on c3, d4, and e5 form a chain based at c3. Black might attack d4 with ...c5 to undermine e5, or prepare pressure on c3 if the position allows. The best target depends on access.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why can undermining a supporter be stronger than attacking the advanced pawn directly?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The advanced pawn may be well protected, while its support is easier to challenge. Removing support can force several weaknesses to appear together.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Trace pawn support backward to find useful break points.